

1. At school — school

Group shown first	Options at 16
Qualification options	Main: a_level · t_level · vocational Later on: bachelors · foundation_degree · hnc · hnd · htq
Apprenticeship options	Main: intermediate · advanced Later on: higher · degree
Jobs	later on (under 18 must keep learning)

2. Sixth form or college — sixth_form

Group shown first	After 18
Qualification options	Main: bachelors · foundation_degree · hnc · hnd · htq Later on: a_level · t_level · vocational
Apprenticeship options	Main: intermediate · advanced · higher · degree
Jobs	main

3. University or graduate — university

Group shown first	University and graduate routes
Qualification options	Main: postgraduate
Apprenticeship options	Later on: higher · degree
Jobs	main

4. Working or retraining — adult

Group shown first	After 18
Qualification options	Main: bachelors · foundation_degree · hnc · hnd · htq · access_to_he Later on: vocational · postgraduate
Apprenticeship options	Main: intermediate · advanced · higher · degree
Jobs	main

Fallback: not answered — unknown (set by us, not the user)	
Group shown first	Options at 16
Qualification options	Main: bachelors · foundation_degree · hnc · hnd · htq Later on: a_level · t_level · vocational · access_to_he · postgraduate
Apprenticeship options	Main: intermediate · advanced · higher · degree
Jobs	main

Client rules, checked

- ✓ **T Levels only for 16-19:** school and sixth form only. Not adult, not university.
- ✓ **Under 18 keeps learning:** jobs only "later on" for school.
- ✓ **Apprenticeships from 16:** main for school.
- ✓ **Graduate placement for university only:** the career report only suggests it to university students and graduates.

How the new "stage" feature will work

1. At sign-up, the user picks their stage

Where are you now?

- At school (Year 10–11)
- Sixth form or college
- University or graduate
- Working or retraining

If they skip it, we show a general mix so they never see an empty screen. They can change it later in their profile.

2. They pick the courses and apprenticeships they're interested in

The choices depend on their stage, and they can pick more than one.

Stage	Courses they can pick	Apprenticeships they can pick
At school	A levels, T Levels, college courses — then degrees, HNC/HND later on	Intermediate, Advanced — then Higher, Degree later on
Sixth form or college	Degrees, foundation degrees, HNC/HND, higher technical — then A levels, T Levels, college courses	All levels
University or graduate	Master's and postgraduate	Higher and Degree, later on
Working or retraining	Degrees, HNC/HND, higher technical, Access to HE — then college courses, master's	All levels

All of this is saved in their profile.

3. Their career plan follows their stage

When they open a career, the step-by-step plan only suggests routes that fit where they are. A Year 11 student is never told to do a graduate placement, and anyone under 18 is never told to leave education for a full-time job.

4. Career pages show only what fits them

Today, a career page shows every course and apprenticeship for that career. Now it also shows only the types the user picked.

Sara, at school, opens "Accountant":

T Level in Accounting and Level 2-3 apprenticeships come first.
Degrees and higher apprenticeships appear lower down, under "later on".
Master's courses don't appear at all.

Jobs are shown according to their stage too. School students see them lower down, because under 18 you must stay in learning.

5. Every course and apprenticeship gets a label

We add one label to each course (A level, T Level, degree...) and each apprenticeship (intermediate, advanced, higher, degree). AI reads each listing once and assigns it, and new listings are labelled automatically as they come in. The original course and apprenticeship information isn't changed.

England's rules are built in: under 18 must stay in learning, apprenticeships from 16, T Levels for ages 16-19, and graduate options only for university students and graduates.

Three more things

Near me search stays the same.

The search works exactly as it does now, with the same request and the same response. The only difference is that the backend quietly applies the user's stage and choices. Users who haven't picked a stage see exactly what they see today.

The career report follows the stage too.

Today the report explains how to become that career. Now it also shows the routes open to the user at their stage, with key facts such as length, level, cost and age. Those facts come from one checked list, so they're always accurate. This will add in the report

Your options at 16

- A levels
- T Levels ← tap
- Apprenticeship
- Work with part-time study

T Levels

A 2-year course, same size as 3 A levels,
with an industry placement.

Level 3 · 2 years · Free · Ages 16–19

Who can apply: ...

[Find T Levels near you]

Each course and apprenticeship says if it's "now" or "later on".

We add one new field, prominence, to each course and apprenticeship. It's main for the user's next step and more for later on, so the app can show a "Later on" heading. Nothing else in the response changes.